

Kneeling Vespers

As sung on Vespers on the day of Pentecost.

This service: <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/kneeling-vespers.docx>

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/kneeling-vespers.pdf>

Also: Excerpts¹, partial or entire, of the Kneeling Prayers From Vespers on the Evening of Pentecost, Useful for private prayer:

- For supplication and intercession for the living
- For supplication and intercession for the dead and those in Hades
- In the evening

<http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/kneeling-prayers-of-pentecost-for-personal-prayer.doc>

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Deacon: In peace let us pray to the Lord.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: For the peace from above, and the salvation of our souls, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For the peace of the whole world, the good estate of the holy churches of God, and the union of all, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For this holy temple, and for them that with faith, reverence, and the fear of God enter herein, let us pray to the Lord

Deacon: For great lord and father, His Holiness Patriarch N.; for our lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan N., First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad; for our lord the Most Reverend Archbishop (or Bishop) N. for the venerable priesthood, the diaconate in Christ, for all the clergy and people, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For this land, its authorities and armed forces, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For the God-preserved Russian Land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: That He may deliver His people from enemies both visible and invisible, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For this city (or this town, or this holy monastery), for every city and country, and the faithful that dwell therein, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For seasonable weather, abundance of the fruits of the earth, and peaceful times, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For travelers by sea, land and air; for the sick, the suffering, the imprisoned, and for their salvation, let us pray to the Lord.

Special Petitions:

Deacon: For the people that stand here and await the grace of the Holy Spirit, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For those that bow their hearts and knees before the Lord, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: That we may be strengthened unto the performance of God-pleasing things, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: That we may be delivered from all tribulation, wrath, and necessity, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: Help us, save us, have mercy on us, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Priest: For unto Thee is due all glory, honour and worship; to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Chanters: Amen.

Deacon: That His abundant mercies may be sent down upon us, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: That He may accept the bending of our knees as incense before Him, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: For those that need help from Him, let us pray to the Lord.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Chanters: To Thee O Lord.

Deacon: Again and again with knees bowed down, let us pray to the Lord.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

And all the people and clergy bow their knees, and the priest reads the first prayer from the Royal Doors, facing the people:

Priest: O Most-pure, spotless,
unoriginate, invisible,
incomprehensible, unsearchable,
immutable, invincible,
immeasurable, forbearing Lord,
Who alone hast immortality, Who
dweldest in light unapproachable,
Who hast made heaven and earth
and sea, and all that is therein, Who
unto all grantest their petitions
before thy ask: We pray Thee and
we ask Thee, O Master, Lover of
mankind, the Father of our Lord and
God and Saviour Jesus Christ, Who
for us men and for our salvation,
came down from the heavens and
was incarnate of the Holy Spirit and
the Ever-virgin Mary, the most
glorious Theotokos; Who, having
first taught in words, and

afterwards instructed by deed,
when He had endured the saving
Passion, granted unto us, Thy lowly
and sinful and unworthy servants a
precept that we should offer
prayers unto Thee, with bowing of
the neck and knees, for our own
sins, and for the errors of the
people. Do Thou Thyself, O
Plenteously Merciful One and Lover
of mankind, hearken unto us in the
day when we call upon Thee, and
especially on this day of Pentecost,
whereon after the Ascension of our
Lord Jesus Christ into the heavens,
and His sitting at the right hand of
Thee, God and the Father, He sent
down upon His holy disciples and
apostles the Holy Spirit, Who rested
upon each of them, and all were

filled with His inexhaustible grace,
and spake in other tongues of Thy
greatness and did prophesy. Now,
therefore, do Thou hearken unto us
who pray unto Thee, and remember
us the lowly and condemned, and
turn again the captivity of our souls,
having Thy loving-kindness
interceding for us. Accept us who
fall down before Thee and shout:
We have sinned; on Thee were we
cast from the womb, from our
mother's womb, Thou art our God.
But inasmuch as our days were
consumed in vanity, we were bereft
of Thy help, we deprived ourselves
of any defense; but presuming upon
Thy compassions, we cry: The sins
of our youth and ignorances
remember not, and from our secret
sins cleanse us, and cast us not
away in the time of our old age,
when our strength faileth; forsake

And he addeth also this prayer:

Blessed art Thou, O Lord, Master
Almighty, Who didst illumine the

us not even until we return again
into the earth, vouchsafe us to
return unto Thee; attend to us
through Thy good favour, and
grace; measure our transgressions
with Thy compassions, set the abyss
of Thy compassions against the
multitude of our sins. Look down
from Thy holy height, O Lord, upon
Thy people standing before Thee
and looking for abundant mercies
from Thee. Visit us with Thy
goodness, deliver us from the
assaults of the devil; establish our
life upon Thy holy and sacred
commandments. Commit Thy
people unto a faithful guardian
angel, gather all into Thy kingdom,
grant pardon unto them that hope
in Thee; remit their sins and ours.
Cleanse us by the working of Thy
Holy Spirit; destroy the wiles of the
enemy directed against us.

day with the light of the sun, and
makest the night clear with fiery

redness, Who hast vouchsafed us to pass through the length of the day, and to approach the beginning of the night: Hearken unto our supplications, and those of all Thy people, forgiving us all our sins, voluntary and involuntary. Accept our evening supplications, and send down a multitude of Thy mercies, and Thy compassions upon Thine inheritance. Defend us with Thy holy angels, arm us with the weapon of Thy righteousness;

compass us about with Thy truth, keep us by Thy might, deliver us from every attack, every plot laid by the adversary. Grant unto us that this evening, with the approaching night, and all the days of our life, may be perfect, holy, peaceful, sinless, without temptations, undisturbed; through the intercessions of the holy Theotokos, and of all the saints who from the ages have been pleasing to Thee.

Deacon: Help us, save us, have mercy on us, raise us up, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Chanters: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For Thine it is to show mercy and to save us, O Lord our God, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Chanters: Amen.

Deacon: Let us all say with our whole soul and with our whole mind, let us say.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: O Lord Almighty, the God of our fathers, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Have mercy on us, O God, according to Thy great mercy, we pray Thee, hearken and have mercy.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

Deacon: Again we pray for our great lord and father, His Holiness Patriarch *N.*; for our lord the Very Most Reverend Metropolitan *N.*, First Hierarch of the Russian Church Abroad; for our lord the Most Reverend *(Archbishop or Bishop) N.*; and all our brethren in Christ.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

Deacon: Again we pray for this land, its authorities and armed forces.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

Deacon: Again we pray for the God-preserved Russian land and its Orthodox people both in the homeland and in the diaspora and for their salvation.

Deacon: Again we pray to the Lord our God that He may deliver His people from enemies visible and invisible, and confirm in us oneness of mind, brotherly love and piety.

Deacon: Again we pray for the blessed and ever-memorable founders of this holy temple *(if it be a monastery: this holy monastery)*; and for all our fathers and brethren gone to their rest before us, and the Orthodox here and everywhere laid to rest.

Deacon: Again we pray for mercy, life, peace, health, salvation, visitation, pardon and remission of sins of the servants of God, the brethren of this holy temple *(if it be a monastery: this holy monastery)*.

Deacon: Again we pray for them that bring offerings and do good works in this holy and all-venerable temple; for them that minister and them that chant, and for all the people here present, that await of Thee great and abundant mercy.

Priest: For a merciful God art Thou, and the Lover of mankind, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Chanters: Amen.

Deacon: Again and again with knees bowed down, let us pray to the Lord.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

And we bow our knees as before mentioned. The priest reads the second prayer in the hearing of all:

Priest: O Lord Jesus Christ our God,
Who hast bestowed upon men Thy
peace, and the gift of the Holy
Spirit; Who, while still on earth and
present with us, didst grant an
inalienable inheritance to the
faithful, but more visibly hast sent
down this grace today upon Thy
disciples and apostles, and hast
strengthened their lips with fiery
tongues, whereby we, together with
the whole race of mankind, having
received the knowledge of God in
their own tongues in the hearing of
our own ears, have been
enlightened by the light of the
Spirit, and have been changed from
delusion as from out of darkness,
and through the distribution of the
material and fiery tongues, and the
supernatural activity were taught to
believe in Thee, and kindled to bless
Thee together with the Father and
the Holy Spirit, in one Godhead and
might and authority: Do Thou, O

Effulgence of the Father, immutable
and immovable Image of His
essence and nature, the Fountain of
wisdom and grace, open the lips of
even me a sinner, and teach me
how I ought to pray and what needs
to pray for; for Thou knowest the
great multitude of my sins, but Thy
loving-kindness will overcome their
immensity. For, behold, in fear I
stand before Thee, having cast the
despair of my soul into the abyss of
Thy mercy: do Thou pilot my life, O
Thou Who by a word dost direct all
creation by the unutterable might
of Thy wisdom, O peaceful Haven of
the storm-tossed, and cause me to
know the way wherein I should
walk. Grant unto my thoughts the
Spirit of Thy wisdom, bestowing
upon my foolishness the Spirit of
understanding; overshadow my
doings with the spirit of Thy fear,
and renew a right spirit within me,
and with Thy governing Spirit

establish my sliding thoughts, so that being daily guided by Thy good Spirit in things profitable, I may be enabled to keep Thy commandments, and ever to bear in mind Thy glorious Coming, and those things worthy of torment that we have done. And do not suffer me to be captivated by the corruptible beauties of this world, but strengthen me in the desire to attain the treasures of the world to come. For Thou hast said, O Master, that whatsoever one may ask in Thy name, he shall freely receive it from Thine ever-existing God and Father. Wherefore, I also, a sinner, at the descent of Thy Holy Spirit, entreat Thy goodness to grant me whatsoever I have asked which is unto salvation. Yea, O Lord, abundant Giver of every benefit, Bestower of good things, for Thou it is Who dost most abundantly grant that which we request; Thou art

And he addeth also this prayer:

O Lord, O Lord, Who hast delivered us from every arrow that flieth by day, deliver us also from everything

compassionate and merciful, having without sin been a participant in our flesh, and in Thy compassionate loving-kindness art inclined toward those that bow the knee before Thee, having been the propitiation for our sins. Grant then, O Lord, Thy compassions unto Thy people; hearken unto us out of Thy holy heaven; sanctify us with the might of Thy saving right hand; shelter us with the shelter of Thy wings, and disdain not the work of Thy hands. Against Thee only have we sinned, but also Thee only do we serve. We know not how to worship an alien god, nor to stretch out our hands, O Master, to another god. Forgive us our sins, and having accepted our supplications made on bended knees, stretch out unto us all a helping hand; receive the prayer of all as pleasing incense, acceptable before Thy most blessed kingdom.

that walketh in darkness. Receive as an evening sacrifice the lifting up of our hands. Vouchsafe us also to

pass through the course of the night without blemish, untempted by evil. And deliver us from every anxiety and fear that come to us from the devil. Grant unto our souls compunction, and unto our thoughts solicitude concerning the trial at Thy dread and righteous judgement. Nail our flesh with the

fear of Thee, and mortify our earthly members, that in the quietness of sleep we may be enlightened by the vision of Thy judgements. Take from us every unseemly dream and pernicious carnal desire. Raise us up at the hour of prayer fortified in faith and advancing in Thy commandments.

Deacon: Help us, save us, have mercy on us, raise us up, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Chanters: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: Through the benevolence and goodness of Thine Only-begotten Son, with Whom Thou art blessed, together with Thy most holy, and good, and life-creating Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Chanters: Amen.

Vouchsafe, O Lord

Reader: Vouchsafe, O Lord, to keep us this evening without sin. Blessed art Thou, O Lord, the God of our fathers, and praised and glorified is Thy name unto the ages. Amen.

Let Thy mercy, O Lord, be upon us, according as we have hoped in Thee. Blessed art Thou, O Lord, teach me Thy statutes. Blessed art Thou, O Master, give me understanding of Thy statutes. Blessed art Thou, O Holy One, enlighten me by Thy statutes.

O Lord, Thy mercy endureth forever; disdain not the work of Thy hands. To Thee is due praise, to Thee is due a song, to Thee glory is due, to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages. Amen.

Deacon: Again and again with knees bowed down, let us pray to the Lord.

Chanters: Lord, have mercy. *Thrice.*

And while we bow our knees, the priest reads the third prayer:

Priest: O Ever-flowing, living, and Illumining Fountain, O Might creative, co-ever-existing with the Father, Who hast most excellently fulfilled the whole economy concerning the salvation of mankind, O Christ our God; Who hast shattered the indestructible chains of death and the bolts of hades, and hast trampled down a multitude of evil spirits; Who hast given Thyself for us as a blameless offering, and given Thy most pure Body in sacrifice, inviolable and inaccessible for any sin, and through this terrible and ineffable sacred act granted us life eternal; Who hast descend into hades and broken the eternal bars, and showed the way up, to those that sat in darkness; Who with divinely-wise allurements hast caught the origin of evil and

the serpent of the abyss, and having bound him with the chains of darkness in Tartarus and unquenchable fire, and having confined him in outer darkness by Thy boundless might, O pre-eminent Wisdom of the Father, Thou hast appeared as a great Helper unto the unfortunate, and hast enlightened those sitting in darkness and the shadow of death. Do Thou, O Lord of everlasting glory, beloved Son of the Father Most High, Light ever-existing of Light ever-existing, Sun of righteousness: Hearken unto us that pray unto Thee, and grant rest to the souls of Thy servants, our fathers and brethren departed before us, and the rest of our kindred according to the flesh, and all our fellow-believers, of whom

we make commemoration now, for
Thou hast dominion over all, and
upholdest in Thy hand all the ends
of the earth. O Master Almighty,
God of the fathers and Lord of
Mercy, Creator of both the mortal
and immortal race, and of all the
nature of man; of that which
cometh into being, and again
passeth away; of life and death; of
sojourn here, and translation
beyond this world; Thou dost
measure out the years unto the
living, and appointest the time for
death, Thou bringest into, and
ledest out of, hades, Thou dost
bind in infirmity and loosest in
strength; the present dost Thou
arrange according to need, and the
future Thou directest profitably;
those smitten with the sting of
death Thou gladdenest with the
hope of resurrection. Do Thou
Thyself then, O Master of all, O God
our Savior, Thou hope of all the
ends of the earth and of them that

be far off at sea, Who hast also on
this last and great and salutary day
of the feast of Pentecost shown
unto us the mystery of the Holy,
consubstantial, co-eternal,
indivisible and unmingled Trinity;
and in the coming down and
descent didst pour out Thy Holy and
life-giving Spirit in the form of
tongues of fire upon Thy holy
apostles, and appointed these as
evangelists of our pious Faith,
showing them to be confessors and
proclaimers of the True Theology,
Who also on this all-perfect and
saving feast hast deigned to receive
propitiatory prayers for those that
are kept in hades, giving us great
hope that through Thee release and
consolation may be sent down to
those held there in bondage of
vileness. Hearken unto us, Thy lowly
servants that pray unto Thee, and
give rest to Thy servants departed
before us, in a place of light, a place
of green pasture, in a place of

refreshment, whence all sickness,
sorrow, and sighing are fled away;
and commit their souls to the
tabernacles of the righteous, and
vouchsafe unto them peace and
release; for not the dead shall

praise Thee, O Lord, nor those that
be in hades dare to offer confession
to Thee, but we the living will bless
Thee and will pray and bring
propitiatory prayers and sacrifices
unto Thee for their souls.

And he addeth also this prayer:

O God great, eternal, and holy, Who
lovest mankind and hast vouchsafed
us to stand in this very hour before
Thine unapproachable glory in song
and praise of Thy wonders: Cleanse
us, Thine unworthy servants, and
grant us the grace with a broken
heart and without pride to offer
unto Thee the Thrice-holy Doxology,
and thanksgiving for Thy great gifts,
which Thou hast conferred upon us
and always conferrest upon us.
Remember, O Lord, our weakness,
and destroy us not with our
iniquities; but deal with our humility
in great mercy, that having escaped
the darkness of sin, we may walk in
the day of righteousness, and
having put on the armour of light,

we may abide unassailed from all
snares of the evil one, and with
boldness glorify Thee, the only true
God and Lover of mankind. For
Thine is the truly and really great
mystery, O Master and Maker of all,
the temporary dissolution of Thy
creatures, and thereafter their re-
integration and repose unto the
ages; we acknowledge Thy grace in
everything, for our coming into this
world, and our departure, our hope
of resurrection and life
incorruptible, faithfully pledged
unto us through thy promise, which
we shall receive in the future at Thy
Second Coming. For Thou art also
the Author of our resurrection and
the incorruptible and man-loving

Judge of those who have lived, and
the Master and Lord of rewards,
Who also wast joined unto us
equally in flesh and blood, because
of Thine extreme condescension;
and when by Thine own will Thou
didst place Thyself under
temptation, and in Thy tender
compassion didst take our
unavoidable passions, and having
thereby suffered temptation, Thou
art become for us who are tempted
the Helper which Thou Thyself
hadst promised; wherefore, also
Thou hast led us unto Thy
passionlessness. Accept, therefore,
O Master, our prayers and
supplications, and give rest unto all
the fathers and mothers and
children and the brothers and
sisters and relatives of each one of
us, and all the souls gone to their
rest before us; and commit their
spirits unto the hope of resurrection
unto life eternal, and inscribe their
names in the Book of Life, in the

bosom of Abraham, and Isaac, and
Jacob, in the land of the living, in
the Kingdom of Heaven, in the
Paradise of delight, by Thy radiant
angels bringing all into Thy holy
habitations, and raising up also our
bodies in the day which Thou hast
appointed according to Thy holy
and sure promise. There is,
therefore, O Lord, no death for Thy
servants, when we leave the body
and come unto Thee, our God, but a
transition from things most
saddening unto things most
beneficial and most delightful, and
unto repose and joy. And though
we have sinned against Thee, be
Thou merciful unto us and them, for
there is no one free from stain in
Thy sight, even if his life be but one
day, unless it be Thou alone, Who
didst manifest Thyself sinless upon
the earth, O our Lord Jesus Christ;
of Whom we all hope to obtain
mercy and remission of sins.
Therefore both unto us and them

do Thou, as a good and man-loving God, loose, remit, and pardon our transgressions, voluntary and involuntary, whether in knowledge or in ignorance, manifest and forgotten, whether in deed or thought or word, in all our lives and ways. And unto the departed then, grant Thou freedom and release,

And he addeth also this prayer:

O God, great and most high, Who alone hast immortality, and dwellest in light unapproachable; Who hast fashioned all creation in wisdom; Who hast divided the light from the darkness, and hast set the sun for dominion of the day, the moon and stars for dominion of the night, Who hast vouchsafed unto us sinners at this present hour to come before Thy presence with thanksgiving and to offer unto Thee evening doxology: do Thou Thyself, O Lover of mankind, direct our prayer as incense before Thee and accept it for a sweet-smelling

and bless us that remain here, granting a good and peaceful end unto us and unto all Thy people, and the bowels of mercy and love for mankind do Thou open unto us, at Thy terrible and dread Coming, and make us worthy of Thy kingdom.

savour; grant unto us that the present evening and the coming night be peaceful. Clothe us with the armour of light. Deliver us from the terror by night and from everything that walketh in darkness. And grant that the sleep which Thou hast given for the repose of our infirmity may be free from all fantasies of the devil. Yea, O Master, Giver of good things, may we, being moved to compunction upon our beds, remember Thy name in the night, and, enlightened by meditation on Thy commandments, rise up in

joyfulness of soul to the
glorification of Thy goodness,
offering prayers and supplications
to Thy loving-kindness for our own

sins and for those of all thy people,
whom do Thou visit in mercy,
through the intercessions of the
most holy Theotokos.

Deacon: Help us, save us, have mercy on us, raise us up, and keep us, O God, by Thy grace.

Chanters: Lord have mercy.

Deacon: Calling to remembrance our most holy, most pure, most blessed, glorious Lady Theotokos and Ever-Virgin Mary with all the saints, let us commit ourselves and one another and all our life unto Christ our God.

Chanters: To Thee, O Lord.

Priest: For Thou art the repose of our souls and bodies, and unto Thee do we send up glory: to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, now and ever, and unto the ages of ages.

Chanters: Amen.

The Royal Doors are shut.

Dismissal at the end:

Priest: May Christ our true God, Who, abasing Himself, left the divine bosom of the Father, and came down from the heavens to the earth, and took upon Himself all our nature, and deified it; and afterwards ascended again into the heavens and sat at the right hand of God the Father, and sent down the Divine and Holy Spirit, one in essence, one in power, one in glory, and co-everlasting, upon His holy disciples and apostles and through Him did enlighten them, and through them the whole world: through the intercessions of His most pure and most blameless Mother; of the holy, glorious, all-praised preachers of God and the Spirit-bearing apostles; and of all the saints, have mercy on us and save us, for He is good and the Lover of mankind.

ⁱ All of the Kneeling Vespers prayers, with small editing changes (recognized by “...” or *italics* to make the prayers flow better for daily, personal prayer.

This document is at: <http://www.orthodox.net/trebnic/kneeling-prayers-of-pentecost-for-personal-prayer.doc>
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The full text of the Prayers is at: <http://www.orthodox.net/services/kneeling-prayers-of-pentecost.doc>
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This document can be printed as is, or made into a booklet, with software such as “Clickbook”

The endnotes are designed to be used when teaching these prayers in catechesis classes. Our theology is open, and accessible to everyone, in our prayers. Those who are Orthodox, and those who want to learn about Orthodox Christianity, must study the prayers of the church AND PRAY THEM to understand the church.